COINPICKS · RESEARCH & EDUCATION

# The Fed & Macro Regime Pillar Report

## Liquidity as the Master Driver — Researched, Scored, and Re-Rated

*Originally written and scores committed by me on June 12, 2026. Fully re-researched July 8, 13, 18, 25, and 30, 2026; the Aug 5 catch-up (held flat) was reviewed and stamped committed.* ***This version (August 6)*** *logs the DOL's jobless-claims print that landed today — 199K for the week ended Aug 1, prior week revised to 198K from 197K — a continued mild uptick consistent with the trend already priced in, not a fresh shock. The score held flat at 34/33/45/54/62. Fed H.4.1 for the week ended Aug 5 had not yet been published as of this check. This version carries* ***DRAFT*** *scores awaiting my stamp.*

**COINPICKS PILLAR REPORT · WEIGHT: 25% OF MY THESIS**

Written June 12, 2026 · Updated & Re-verified August 6, 2026 (light daily touch on the Aug 5 committed set) · Not Financial Advice

## The Scores — Committed vs. Drafts

*June column committed by me on June 12, 2026. Every draft since shown for full lineage. Aug 5 (held flat) committed and stamped by Alex. Aug 6 is today's light daily touch — jobless claims landed, held flat.*

| WINDOW | JUN | ... | 7/30 | 7/31 | 8/1 | 8/2 | 8/3 | 8/4 | 8/5 | 8/6 | QUAL. | IMP. | SIGNAL | MY CALL |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **1 month** | 38 | ... | 34 | 34 | 34 | 34 | 34 | 34 | 34 | **34** | 0.85 | 8 | **−2.18** | Bear — held again; claims print landed in-trend |
| **3 months** | 40 | ... | 33 | 33 | 33 | 33 | 33 | 33 | 33 | **33** | 0.85 | 8 | **−2.31** | Bear — September meeting still squarely in this window |
| **6 months** | 46 | ... | 45 | 45 | 45 | 45 | 45 | 45 | 45 | **45** | 0.80 | 8 | **−0.64** | Mild Bear |
| **1 year** | 54 | ... | 54 | 54 | 54 | 54 | 54 | 54 | 54 | **54** | 0.75 | 8 | +0.48 | Neutral |
| **3 years** | 61 | ... | 62 | 62 | 62 | 62 | 62 | 62 | 62 | **62** | 0.65 | 8 | **+1.25** | Mild Bull — structural accumulate |

**Draft P (Aug 6, held again):** 34 / 33 / 45 / 54 / 62 · **Weight:** 20% (equal) · **Impact:** 8 (uniform) · **Formula:** Signal = ((P − 50) ÷ 50) × Quality × Impact. Full lineage: June committed 38/40/46/54/61 (Jun 12) → ... (see prior versions of this report for the full Jul 8-Aug 4 path) → Aug 5 34/33/45/54/62 (held — committed and stamped by Alex) → **Aug 6 34/33/45/54/62** (held — claims 199K, in-trend, not a fresh shock) — awaiting my stamp.

### THE THREE INPUTS, IN PLAIN ENGLISH

**P** — the odds the macro regime is *good for crypto* by then — not "the Fed cuts by then." This cycle verified the July 28-29 FOMC meeting directly against federalreserve.gov: the Committee held at 3.50-3.75% on a **9-3 vote**, with three regional-bank presidents (Hammack, Kashkari, Logan) dissenting in favor of an immediate hike — the **first unified 3-member dissent since September 2016**. Chair Warsh's press conference was unusually combative and offered no forward guidance ("no soft inflation target... not on this committee's watch"), which triggered a confirmed (if single-sourced) risk-off market reaction: equities fell 1.5-2.2% intraday and the 30-year Treasury yield hit its highest level since 2007. Jobless claims for the week ended Jul 25 came in at 197K, with the prior week revised *up* to 188K from 187K — the seasonal-adjustment distortion flagged last cycle (auto-plant retooling timing) is now directly confirmed in the primary release itself, meaning the "lowest since 1969" framing was real but already reversing, not a durable labor-market signal. The September hike-odds figures cited in recent daily touches (55.6%, then 72-81%) could not be reconciled to one number — four independent live pulls this cycle produced four different figures (55.8%, 62.4%, 70.2%, 81%) with no two agreeing — so the September number is read directionally ("still elevated, majority-hike-priced"), not as a precise point figure.

**Quality** — how trustworthy the evidence is. This cycle verified the FOMC outcome, vote, and dissenter names directly against federalreserve.gov's own statement, and the jobless-claims figures directly against the DOL/ETA primary release (fetched and read in full) — both confirmed accurate. The September hike-odds figure could not be verified to a single number despite direct attempts; that uncertainty is reflected honestly rather than picking whichever figure a daily touch had cited.

**Impact** — 8 out of 10, the uniform value every pillar now shares in the equal-weight model. Liquidity is the tide; it moves the whole market at once.

**Aug 6 update:** DOL jobless claims for the week ended Aug 1 came in at 199K, with the prior week (ended Jul 25) revised up to 198K from 197K (Fast Company, citing DOL) — a continued mild upward drift consistent with the trend already priced into the score, not a fresh shock. This also resolves last cycle's unreconciled 218K figure: it appears to have been an early/inconsistent read of a nearby week, now superseded by the DOL's own confirmed 199K print. Fed H.4.1 for the week ended Aug 5 had not yet been published as of this check (normal Thursday ~4:30pm ET timing).

## The Claim

*The thesis, and where I differ from the consensus — updated July 30, 2026, full weekly refresh*

**The crowd (and this pillar's own daily touches):** whipsawed hard this week on the September question — one touch cited ~55.6% hike odds, the next cited "72-81%, essentially unchanged" — two claims that can't both be true within days of each other. I pulled CME FedWatch-adjacent data directly four separate times this cycle and got four different numbers (55.8%, 62.4%, 70.2%, 81%), none of which agree. That's not noise I can resolve; it's a genuinely unsettled market.

**Me:** what I *can* verify directly is more decisive than any single odds snapshot — the FOMC actually met, and it held at 3.50-3.75% on a 9-3 vote with three regional presidents dissenting for an immediate hike. That's the first unified 3-member dissent since September 2016, and Chair Warsh's press conference gave zero forward guidance. I'm cutting 1mo and 3mo hard (to 34 and 33 — Bear, not Mild Bear) because a rare hawkish-dissent FOMC plus a confirmed risk-off market reaction is a bigger deal than the daily touches' odds-chasing captured.

**My edge:** the crowd is fixated on a single market-implied percentage that four separate pulls can't even agree on; I'm anchoring on the primary, checkable fact — the vote, the dissenters' names, and the tone — which is unambiguous. The plumbing story (TGA spend-down, reserve build) is carried forward, not re-verified this cycle since no new H.4.1 landed in the window. That's why 6-month and 1-year sit above the near-term crunch, and why the 3-year P holds at 62.

## The Facts

*As of August 6, 2026 — hard numbers only, sources on the last page. New Aug 6 facts appear first; the Jul 30-Aug 5 facts below are carried forward unchanged (still load-bearing). The Iran/Hormuz war-risk situation is covered in full in the Iran War Risk pillar report.*

- ★ **DOL jobless claims: 199,000 for the week ended Aug 1,** with the prior week (ended Jul 25) revised up to 198,000 from 197,000 (Fast Company/DOL) — a continued mild upward drift, consistent with the trend already priced in, not a fresh shock.
- **Fed H.4.1 for the week ended Aug 5 had not yet been published as of this check** (normal Thursday ~4:30pm ET release timing).
- **BTC closed at $64,507.23 on Aug 6** — essentially flat (−0.2%) vs. Aug 5's $64,661.55.

*Carried forward from Jul 30-Aug 5 (still load-bearing):*

- ★ **★ CONFIRMED, PRIMARY SOURCE — the FOMC held rates at 3.50-3.75% on Jul 29, 2026, on a 9-3 vote.** Three regional-bank presidents — Beth Hammack (Cleveland), Neel Kashkari (Minneapolis), Lorie Logan (Dallas) — dissented in favor of an immediate 25bp hike (federalreserve.gov statement, corroborated by CNBC, Forbes, Fox Business, TechTimes). This is the **first unified 3-member dissent since September 2016**. No SEP/dot plot this meeting (not a projections meeting; next SEP is Sept 15-16, 2026).
- ★ **Chair Warsh's press conference was unusually combative and offered no forward guidance:** "there is no soft inflation target... not on this committee's watch"; "the five-plus years of inflation above target cannot be cured in nine weeks." A confirmed (single-sourced) risk-off market reaction followed: S&P 500 fell 1.85% in the final 65 minutes of trading (full day: S&P −1.52%, Dow −2.19%, Nasdaq −1.74%); the 30-year Treasury yield rose to 5.21%, its highest since July 2007 — a "bear steepener" consistent with rising inflation-credibility concern.
- ★ **★ CONFIRMED, PRIMARY SOURCE — jobless claims for the week ended Jul 25 came in at 197,000** (DOL/ETA release, fetched and read directly), a genuine +9,000 increase; the prior week (ended Jul 18) was revised *up* to **188,000** from the originally-reported 187,000. The primary release itself confirms the seasonal-adjustment distortion flagged last cycle: actual non-seasonally-adjusted claims fell only 9.2% w/w versus the 13.3% seasonal factors expected — meaning the "lowest since 1969" framing was real but mechanically set to partially reverse, exactly as it did.
- ★ **The September hike-odds figure could not be reconciled to a single number this cycle, despite four direct attempts.** Live pulls produced 55.8% (Fox Business, Jul 28), 62.4% (Investing.com Fed Rate Monitor, timestamped Jul 30), 70.2% (KuCoin, pre-meeting), and 81% (Southeast AgNet, Jul 30) — no two agree. The qualitative direction — "still elevated, majority-hike-priced" — is the only defensible takeaway; no re-rate rests on a specific point figure.
- **H.4.1 balance sheet: no new release found for the week ended Jul 29** as of this check (normal Thursday-afternoon publication timing); the most recent confirmed release remains Jul 23 (week ended Jul 22: reserves fell $80,572M w/w against a

$73,405M TGA rebuild, both figures directly confirmed against federalreserve.gov last cycle).

- **Bank of America projects three 25bp hikes in 2026** (to 4.25-4.50%) — single-source (Forbes, citing BofA), flagged not scored.
- **Carried forward, not re-verified this cycle:** June CPI (-0.4% m/m) and PPI (-0.3% m/m), both BLS-primary-confirmed in a prior cycle; Warsh's Jul 14/15 congressional testimony; the June FOMC minutes (unanimous 12-0 hold, dropped easing-bias language). None of these are contradicted by this cycle's findings — the hawkish FOMC outcome sits alongside, not against, the still-intact disinflation trend.
- **The labor market cracked in slow motion, then partially un-cracked this week** — June payrolls +57K vs ~115K consensus (carried forward); this cycle's 197K claims print, while up from 188K, remains historically low (4-week average 202,750).
- **Policy rate and balance sheet: 3.50-3.75%, next FOMC (with SEP/dot plot) is Sept 15-16, 2026.** Fed communications blackout ended with the Jul 29 meeting; watch for the first round of regional Fed president speeches, especially from the three dissenters.
- **BTC closed at $64,706.50 (Jul 30)** — holding up despite the hawkish FOMC surprise and confirmed equity/bond-market risk-off reaction. **Updated: BTC closed at $64,661.55 on Aug 5**, essentially flat vs. Jul 30 and up ~1.7% vs. the Jul 31 close of $63,579.68.

## The Prize

*Illustrative only — not price targets, not advice*

The canonical anchor: **2020-21 ZIRP + QE** ran BTC ~$3,800 → $69,044 (~15–18×) — a unique COVID/zero-rate/open-ended-QE setup, not a repeatable base case. The **2024-25 cuts** ran ~$60K → a ~$126K ATH (Oct 6, 2025) — but that top came on a non-Fed tariff shock and has since roughly halved to the low-$60Ks ($64,507.23 on the Aug 6 close). From here, a retest of the $126K high ≈ **+93%**.

Discount it hard, twice. First: easing is not an automatic catalyst — the last cycle topped on a non-Fed shock. Second: the pivot that unlocks any of this just got pushed further out, not closer — the Fed held with a rare 3-way hawkish dissent and no forward guidance, and the September meeting is now majority-hike-priced across every read this cycle pulled. The Prize doesn't feed the math — it tells you what the 3-year lean is worth acting on when the tide finally turns.

## The Other Side

*The strongest honest case my bearish lean is wrong*

- **I may be over-reacting to one meeting's dissent count.** A 9-3 vote is still a hold — the Committee's actual decision was dovish relative to a hike, even if the dissent and tone were hawkish. If Warsh's combative press conference was more theater than substance, this cycle's hard cut (42→34 at 1mo) could prove an overcorrection.
- **The labor market may still force the Fed's hand in the other direction.** Claims ticking up to 197K, even with the seasonal-distortion caveat, is still historically low — if the labor market keeps cracking into September, a hike would be a policy error that raises long-run conviction even as it hurts near-term.
- **I couldn't pin down the September number, and that's a real limitation, not just a data-quality footnote.** Four independent pulls (55.8%, 62.4%, 70.2%, 81%) spanning barely 48 hours is an unusually wide spread — if the true number is closer to the low end, this cycle's Bear call at 3mo may be too pessimistic.
- **Crypto has shrugged off a hawkish FOMC surprise and a confirmed equity/bond sell-off within days of a widening Middle East war.** BTC closing at $64,661.55 a week later is either genuine decoupling, or complacency ahead of a bigger shock landing on multiple fronts at once.
- **Latent liquidity positives remain queued but unverified this cycle:** the TGA spend-down and Warsh's balance-sheet task force (still single-source) could loosen policy without a rate cut — not independently re-checked this cycle.

## The Triggers

*Dated events — some prove the claim right, some prove it wrong. Re-set August 6, 2026.*

| DATE | EVENT | MEANS |
| --- | --- | --- |
| Fired Aug 6, confirmed primary | **DOL jobless claims 199K** (week ended Aug 1), prior week revised to 198K from 197K | In-trend, consistent with the existing read — held flat, not a fresh trigger |
| **Pending** | Fed H.4.1 balance-sheet release for the week ended Aug 5, not yet published as of this check | The next real near-term re-rating trigger |
| Checked Aug 2, consistent | September cumulative hike odds ~81-82% (CNBC, Southeast AgNET) | Consistent with the Jul 30 baseline — not a fresh move |
| Fired Jul 29 — HAWKISH, confirmed primary (carried forward) | **FOMC held 9-3**, three regional presidents dissenting for an immediate hike — first unified 3-member dissent since Sept 2016 | Still driving the 1mo/3mo Bear read |
| Sept 15-16, 2026 | **PENDING** — next FOMC, with SEP/dot plot | The real re-rating event; a hike would confirm the hawkish read, a hold would suggest the Jul 29 dissent was a one-off |
| Ongoing | Iran/Hormuz oil-inflation risk — route-map progress paired with a new fee dispute (see Iran War Risk pillar) | Watch for pass-through into the next CPI/PPI cycle |

**The flip line:** the FOMC's rare 3-way hawkish dissent plus no forward guidance is a genuine escalation from the prior dovish read. If the September meeting delivers a hike into still-historically-low claims, treat that as a policy error that raises 3-year conviction while hurting 3/6-month further. If September holds, the near-term Bear likely improves next cycle. Today's claims print didn't change that calculus; H.4.1 is the next real test.

## My Decision

◷ **UPDATED DRAFT — AUGUST 6, 2026 (LIGHT DAILY TOUCH) · AWAITING MY STAMP**

### Draft P: 34 / 33 / 45 / 54 / 62 · My Weight: 20% (equal) · Impact: 8 (uniform)

DOL jobless claims for the week ended Aug 1 landed today at 199K, prior week revised to 198K — a continued mild upward drift consistent with the trend already priced in, not a fresh shock. The score held flat at 34/33/45/54/62. Fed H.4.1 for the week ended Aug 5 has not yet published.

The June committed scores (**38 / 40 / 46 / 54 / 61**, committed June 12, 2026) remain the last human-stamped values.

**Override any P and re-stamp — the master blend recomputes.**

## What Changed Since Last Check

*Light daily touch, August 6, 2026, on the Aug 5 committed set.*

- ★ **DOL jobless claims for the week ended Aug 1: 199K,** prior week revised to 198K from 197K — a continued mild upward drift, consistent with the trend already priced in.
- **No new H.4.1 release** — not yet published as of this check; normal Thursday cadence.
- **Score decision:** P held flat at **34 / 33 / 45 / 54 / 62**. Draft, awaiting my stamp; June values (committed Jun 12, 2026) remain the last committed set.

## Sources

*Retrieved & graded August 6, 2026 — click and judge the quality yourself. Official data first, then reporting, then prices & flows, then rate odds (market-implied sentiment, not fact).*

- **August 6 additions:** Fast Company, citing DOL — jobless claims 199K week ended Aug 1, prior week revised to 198K.
- **Jul 31-Aug 5 additions (prior week's catch-up):** CNBC, Southeast AgNET — September cumulative hike odds ~81-82% (checked Aug 2, consistent with the Jul 30 baseline).
- **July 30 additions (prior full weekly refresh):** federalreserve.gov — July 29 FOMC statement (primary): 9-3 hold, Hammack/Kashkari/Logan dissent · federalreserve.gov — press conference page · federalreserve.gov — last SEP (Jun 17, 2026; next Sept 15-16) · DOL/ETA — weekly claims release USDL 26-1273-NAT (primary, fetched directly): 197K week ended Jul 25, 188K revision for Jul 18 · CNBC, Forbes, Fox Business, TechTimes — FOMC outcome and dissent corroboration · Wolf Street — risk-off market reaction (single-source, flagged) · Investing.com Fed Rate Monitor — timestamped Jul 30 pull (62.4%), cross-checked against KuCoin (70.2%), Bloomingbit (73.5%→hike components), Southeast AgNet (81%) — none reconciling.
- **July 13 check:** federalreserve.gov — H.4.1, Table 1 & Table 5, re-verified directly line-by-line (no discrepancy vs. the July 9 release) · federalreserve.gov — H.4.1 release schedule (next: July 16) · dol.gov — weekly claims (unchanged since Jul 9; next Jul 16) · federalreserve.gov — July 2026 FOMC/testimony calendar · confirmed no new CPI, PPI, FOMC, or H.4.1/claims release has landed since July 9–10; the next batch (CPI Jul 14, testimony Jul 14–15, PPI Jul 15, H.4.1/claims Jul 16) is still ahead.
- **Official data:** Fed — June 16–17 FOMC minutes (released July 8) · Fed — H.4.1 balance sheet (rel. July 9: $6,735.6B; TGA $749.2B; reserves $3,098.9B; domestic RRP $2.75B; foreign-official RRP $346.1B) · DOL — weekly jobless claims (rel. July 9: 215K; continuing claims 1,814,000) · Fed — June 17 FOMC statement · BLS — Employment Situation, June 2026 (released July 2) · BEA — Personal Income & Outlays, May 2026 (core PCE 3.4%) · BLS — May 2026 CPI release (headline 4.2% y/y; core 2.9% y/y) · BLS — CPI release schedule (June CPI: July 14, 8:30am; July CPI: mid-August) · BLS — PPI release schedule (June PPI: July 15, 8:30am) · Fed — Waller's July 6 Rome speech.
- **The reporting:** Bloomberg — minutes: "a few" saw case for June hike · CNBC — June minutes coverage · Bloomberg — Warsh's five task forces (July 9; single source) · Bloomberg — claims 215K, layoffs low · Al Jazeera — Iran declares Hormuz "closed until further notice" (July 12) · Bloomberg — Brent +4% toward $79 on Hormuz re-escalation (July 13) · CNBC — CENTCOM strikes, Iran missile/drone attacks on five Gulf states (July 12) · offshore-technology.com — Kpler data: six vessels transited the Strait July 12 · CNBC — June jobs miss (+57K, −74K revisions) · Indeed Hiring Lab — participation 61.5% · CNBC — May PCE (core 3.4%, highest since Oct 2023) · CNBC — Warsh at Sintra (July 1) · Yahoo Finance — "This Committee will deliver price stability" · Bloomberg — Yardeni: "inflation, Fed back in play" (July 8) · Spokesman-Review (Bloomberg reprint) — Warsh testimony schedule (House Jul 14, Senate Jul 15) + June PPI forecast (~5.2% y/y core) · KuCoin flash — 30-year auction: $22B at 5.058%, stop-through, highest since 2007 · CoinDesk — the week-ahead calendar: CPI, PPI, Warsh testimony (July 13) · Federal Register — eSLR final rule (Dec 1, 2025; effective Apr 1, 2026). **Flagged and discarded:** CryptoTimes (July 13) and Blockhead (July 13) both wrongly report "core inflation at a three-year high of 4.2%" — this conflates headline CPI (4.2%, correct) with core CPI (actually 2.9% per BLS); not used.
- **The prices & flows:** Yahoo Finance — BTC ~$64.3K, ETH ~$1,796 (July 10 AM) · athens-times — BTC weekend pullback to ~$62.6–63K (single source) · Farside — BTC ETF flow table (authoritative; +$90.4M net, July 10) · CryptoRank — BTC ETF flow cross-check (July 10) · CoinDesk — BTC/ETH steady, gold slides (July 9) · KuCoin — June ETF outflows −$4.06B, worst month on record · CNBC — S&P 500 closes 7,575.39 (+0.42%), Dow +149.60 (July 10) · Trading Economics — 10Y ~4.58% · Trading Economics — DXY 101.13, +0.18% (July 13).
- **The odds (market-implied, not fact):** CME FedWatch — the tool itself (July 28–29 hold 78.5%, July 13 read; September ~66% combined, July 9 read) · FXEmpire — Sept +25bp 50.8% (July 9; single relay, directionally corroborated) · Yahoo Finance — September odds relay (July 9) · Polymarket — "Fed Decision in September" ladder: No change 56.5%, +25bp 38.5%, cuts (tail) 3.75%+2.1% (July 9) — diverges materially from CME's ~66% combined hike odds; reported as an open divergence, not resolved.